

FreeAgent GoFlex Ultra-portable Drive

Features

- Company: Seagate
- USB 2.0 or 3.0 plug-and-play connectivity
- Includes pre-loaded backup software
- Can be upgraded to USB 3.0, FireWire 800 or eSATA
- Allows you to access your content on your TV, network and on-the-go when combined with other GoFlex devices



Street price: 1TB – ₹ 4950 (₹ 1900 for cable to upgrade to USB 3.0)

Most bulky data—such as music, video, photographs and documents—get minimal benefit from a portable SSD and thus should be stored on a separate hard disk. Unlike hard disks, where 1TB drive is affordable, SSDs' pricing is almost proportional to the capacity.

Though hard disk drives come in various sizes, 320GB capacity offers a fairly good storage capacity.

Included software. Most PSDs come with pre-installed applications such as security programs, sync tools and virtual application platforms.

Factors like ease of use, automatic period back ups and customisation as per the user's needs should be considered while evaluating the software that comes bundled with the hard drive.

Support/warranty. Before investing in a PSD look for manufacturer's customer service through online documentation like FAQs or a knowledge base. Customers should be able to reach customer support by phone or e-mail. A lifetime warranty ensures you'll have your drive for years to come.

Physical features. Ensure that your PSD is ergonomically designed and has practical features with ease-of-use. For example, USB Flash drives come with swivel caps for extra protection. It is better to invest in portable HDDs that do not require any external power source or cord-clutter for operation.

Decide if you need a more protective case. If you're rough on your

drives, hauling them everywhere and dropping them into a briefcase or bag, choose a drive that's robust and can take the abuse.

Noise. Unlike traditional HDDs being mechanically designed, SSDs have no moving parts, meaning no sound while it's operating, and much safer in use.

Applications predominantly define product choice. Easy storage and transport, backup/archival, quick storage and replay of high-definition content needs to be decided first.

Next step would be to decide on devices that best serve the applications available in the market. This should be followed by an evaluation of technical features, support and warranty. Across the board, key technical features that buyers should consider while choosing PSDs are endurance, speed, security, capacity, interface options, cost per GB, in-built data protection and recovery features, bundled software, form factors—colour and shape, robust build quality including water and fire proofing, and lastly regulatory compliance.

One should pay equal attention to the software that comes with the hard drive. Factors like ease of use, automatic period back ups and customisation as per the user's needs should be considered while evaluating the software that comes bundled with the hard drive. ●

The author is assistant editor at EPY

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